# Lecture 5: Participation and Representation (FK)

*Political Science — Master Notes · by Jakob V. Stangel*

**Required reading:** OD ch. 6 (*Institutions of Participation and Representation*)

**Theme of the lecture: Why do some citizens participate while others don't? Why are some interests represented while others aren't?** We examine how different **institutions — specifically electoral and party systems — shape political participation and representation.**

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## OD Ch. 6 — Institutions of Participation and Representation

**Book:** Orvis & Drogus, *Introducing Comparative Politics*, 5th ed., ch. 6.

### Chapter résumé

Looks at the three institutions through which democracies channel **participation and representation** — **electoral systems, parties/party systems, and civil society (interest groups)** — and asks which best represent ordinary and marginalised citizens. It opens with *why anyone participates at all* (a **collective-action problem**), then its analytic core: how **electoral systems** (plurality/SMD · majoritarian · PR · mixed) convert votes into seats and thereby shape the **number of parties** (**Duverger's Law**), proportionality, stability, and the representation of women & minorities. It classifies **party systems**, surveys how parties mobilise (programmatic / clientelist / populist) amid a "crisis of party democracy," contrasts **pluralist vs neocorporatist** interest-group systems, and closes on the master **trade-off (Powell): diverse representation ⇄ clear accountability.**

> ★ **The heart of the chapter: institutions decide who participates and whose interests get represented.** The **electoral system** is the master lever — **SMD/plurality** squeezes politics toward *two parties + clear accountability but wasted votes*; **PR** opens it to *many parties + proportional, diverse representation but coalition instability* (Duverger's Law). Underneath sits one unavoidable **trade-off (Powell): broad representation ⇄ clear accountability/governability.**

**The red thread.** Two questions run through the chapter. ① **Why participate (or not)?** — voting is individually "irrational" (a collective-action problem), so *institutions* raise or lower the cost (PR & simple systems → higher turnout). ② **Whose interests get represented?** — the **electoral system → party system → interest-group system** chain decides. For any case ask: **how do votes become seats · how many parties result · who gets left out (small parties, women, minorities) · and what's traded off (representation vs accountability)?**

### Key concepts / "modes" to use

- **The electoral-system menu: SMD plurality (FPTP) · majoritarian (two-round / alternative vote) · proportional representation (PR) · mixed/semiproportional.**
- **Duverger's Law** — SMD → two parties; PR → multiparty.
- **Party systems** — dominant-party · two-party · multiparty; **sociological** (cleavages) vs **institutional** (electoral rules) origins.

- **Mobilisation types** — programmatic · patronage/clientelist · populist.
- **Interest groups: pluralism** (many, neutral state — US) vs **neocorporatism** (few peak associations bargain with the state — Germany).
- **The Powell trade-off** — representation/participation ⇄ accountability/governability.

## Section-by-section main points

**Lecture frame (FK).** The lecture opens by asking *what representation even is* (**Pitkin**), then works through the institutions that produce it — **electoral systems → party systems → civil society** — and closes with **case studies** (UK, Germany, Japan, Brazil).

### What is representation? — Pitkin's four views

***Core:*** before asking *how* institutions represent, ask *what "representation" means*. **Hanna Pitkin** (*The Concept of Representation*, 1967) distinguishes **four** senses:

- **Formalistic** — the institutional arrangement that **authorises** a representative and holds them **accountable** (elections = the "before" and "after" of representing).
- **Descriptive** — the representative **resembles** the represented (shares gender, ethnicity, class) — "**standing for**" (the case for **quotas** / descriptive representation).
- **Symbolic** — the representative **stands for** the represented symbolically (a leader/flag people identify with).
- **Substantive** — the representative **acts in the interests** of the represented — "**acting for**" (the **delegate** [follow instructions] vs **trustee** [own judgment] debate).
- *Why it matters:* the electoral systems below are really machines for producing one kind of representation or another — **PR** boosts **descriptive** representation (more women/minorities); **SMD** emphasises the **formalistic** local link.

### Why participate? — the collective-action problem

***Core:*** voting is individually "**irrational**" (Downs) — one vote rarely decides anything — so participation is a **collective-action problem** that *institutions* must overcome.

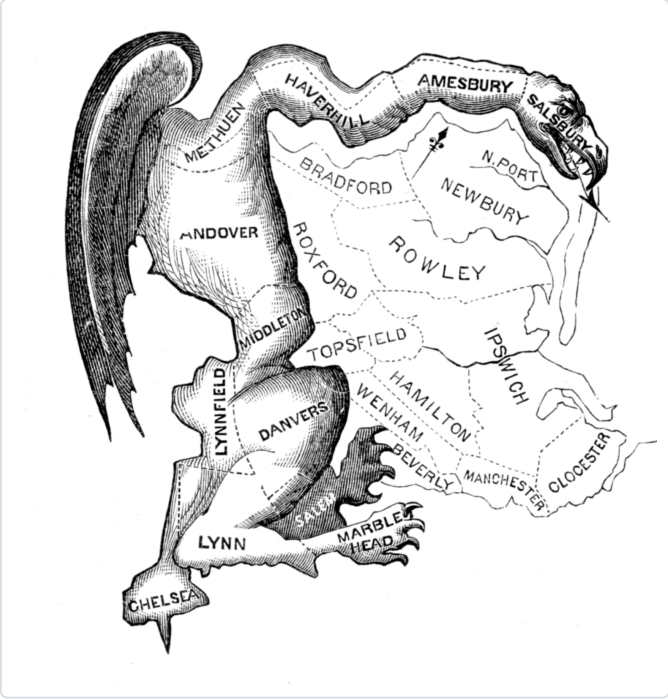
- People vote anyway for **expressive/solidaristic** reasons, charismatic leaders, and to avoid the **emotional cost** of not participating (guilt, exclusion).
- **Institutions shape turnout:** complex systems depress it among the less-educated; **PR/mixed systems raise it** (fewer "wasted votes"); parties & interest groups lower the cost of finding and acting on your interests.

### Electoral systems — *the core of the chapter* ★

***Core:*** the electoral system is the master lever — *on what basis are you represented* (a **district**, a **party/idea**, or a **group**), and *how do votes become seats?*

| System | Votes → seats | Parties (Duverger) | Proportionality | Turnout | Women/minorities | Cases |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SMD plurality (FPTP)** | most votes in each district wins (no majority needed) | **two parties** | **low** (wasted votes) | lower | worse | UK, US, India |
| **Majoritarian** (two-round / **AV** ranked-choice) | need **50%+1** → runoff or reallocate | ~two blocs | low–medium | — | — | France |
| **Proportional (PR)** — closed/open list | seats **= vote share** (national/large districts, a **threshold**) | **multiparty** | **high** | higher | **better** | Israel, Brazil (open) |
| **Mixed / semiproportional** | SMD seats **+** party-list PR | multiparty | high (**compensatory**, Germany) / medium (**noncompensatory**, Japan) | higher | — | Germany, Japan |

- **SMD/FPTP:** *strengths* — strong voter–representative link, single-party government (efficient, accountable); defenders also invoke **virtual representation** (co-partisans elected in *other* districts speak for you). *Weaknesses* — **wasted votes**, **disproportionality** (a party can win many seats on ~35% pluralities; a broad-but-thin party wins almost none), gerrymandering, fewer women/minorities. *(Empirically the SMD "closer link" is weak — Curtice & Shively found no real advantage in voter–rep contact.)*




**How to read it (the original "Gerry-mander," 1812).** SMD only works if someone *draws the district lines* — and whoever draws them can rig outcomes. This famous cartoon mocks a Massachusetts district that Governor **Elbridge Gerry**'s party contorted into a **salamander** shape to pack/crack opponents into losing

configurations. *Gerry + salamander = "gerrymander."* It's the visual shorthand for why single-member districts are vulnerable to **manipulated boundaries** — a weakness PR (large multi-member districts) largely avoids.

- **Majoritarian — two-round runoff & the Alternative Vote.** Unlike FPTP, the winner must clear an **absolute majority (50%+1)**, so the count needs a *second step* FPTP doesn't have. Two ways to get there:
  - **Two-round system (TRS / runoff)** — *France.* **Round 1:** win outright if you get 50%+1; if not, the top candidates go to a **second-round runoff** a week or two later (top two — or in France's legislative version, *everyone above 12.5% of registered voters*), and whoever leads the runoff wins. Voters whose first choice is knocked out get to **re-choose** among those left.
  - **Alternative Vote (AV) / ranked-choice / instant-runoff** — *one ballot,* but you **rank** candidates 1-2-3… Count the 1st preferences; if nobody has 50%+1, **eliminate the last-placed candidate and transfer their ballots to each voter's next-ranked choice**; repeat until someone passes 50%. It's a runoff done "instantly" in a single election.
  - *Mini worked example (AV):* three candidates — **A 40% · B 35% · C 25%**, nobody at 50%. Eliminate **C**; C's voters' 2nd choices split (say **+18%→B, +7%→A**). New totals: **A 47% · B 53% → B wins** — even though A *led* the first count. That flip is the whole point: it rewards the **broadly acceptable** candidate over the one with the biggest *minority*.
  - *Effect:* squeezes extremes, rewards second-choice-friendly candidates, wastes fewer votes than FPTP; produces **~two blocs** but more softly than FPTP. *(Case: **Maine 2018** — first US Congress seat decided by AV; Golden won **50.5–49.5 after trailing on the first count**.)*
- **PR:** *strengths* — few wasted votes, **higher turnout**, far **more women & minorities** (lists + quotas), more information/positions, more egalitarian policy (Orellana). *Weaknesses* — no identifiable individual rep, **coalition instability**, small extremist parties gain outsized leverage; **Kedar:** PR voters even vote for *more extreme* parties on purpose, expecting post-election compromise to pull policy back to the middle.
  - **Closed vs open list — *who decides the order within a party's seats?*** Under PR you vote for a **party**, which then fills its won seats from a ranked **list of candidates**. The two variants differ in *who sets that rank*:
    - **Closed list:** the **party** fixes the order in advance; you vote only for the party, and if it wins *n* seats they go to the top *n* names on the party's list. → **more party control, party discipline, and easy use of quotas** (a party can guarantee women high spots), but voters can't pick the *individual*. *(e.g. Israel.)*
    - **Open list:** you vote for the party **and** for a **specific candidate** within it; the candidates' *own* vote totals decide who gets the party's seats. → **more voter choice over individuals**, but it makes candidates compete against their *own* party-mates → **weaker, more personalist parties.** *(e.g. Brazil — a big reason its parties are so fragmented and weak.)*
- **Mixed:** two ballots (a district candidate + a party list) — blends a personal rep with proportional fairness; **Germany's compensatory** version tops seats up to full proportionality, **Japan's noncompensatory** version keeps SMD & PR separate (less proportional). **AV/ranked-choice** wastes fewer votes than FPTP (Maine 2018 elected the first US Congress seat by AV).
  - **Is Germany still "mixed"? (2023 reform).** You can argue it's **drifting toward pure PR.** Germany's compensatory mechanism caused the Bundestag to balloon (**736 seats in 2021** via overhang + balance seats). The **2023 reform** (first used in the **2025** election) **capped the house at 630** and **abolished overhang & compensatory seats**: a party now gets **only** the seats its **second (list) vote** earns, and district winners are seated **only if their party's list vote covers them** (*Zweitstimmendeckung*) — otherwise the narrowest district winners **lose their seats** even though they won locally. So the **first vote no longer guarantees a personal representative**, and total seats are set almost entirely by the party

vote → many now call it "**personalised PR**" rather than a genuine mixed system. *(The Constitutional Court upheld the cap in 2024 but reinstated the basic-mandate/3-seat clause.)*

- **Redistribution link (Iversen & Soskice — from Lecture 4): PR → the middle class allies with the poor → bigger welfare states**; majoritarian → middle allies with the rich → less. A key reason electoral systems shape *policy*, not just seats (the Sweden vs US welfare puzzle).

**Table 1. Electoral system and the number of years with left and right governments (1945-98)**

| | | Government partisanship | | Proportion of right governments |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Left | Right | |
| Electoral system | Proportional | 342 (8) | 120 (1) | 0.26 |
| | Majoritarian | 86 (0) | 256 (8) | 0.75 |

*Note*: Excludes centrist governments (see text below for details).

**How to read it (Iversen & Soskice).** Count the years each system spent under left vs right government (1945–98). Under **PR**, the right governed only **26%** of the time; under **majoritarian**, the right governed **75%** of the time. Same democracies, opposite tilt — hard evidence that **the electoral system biases *which* side holds power over the long run**, and hence how big the welfare state gets.

## Duverger's Law — and its limits

***Core:* SMD/plurality → two parties** (small parties get squeezed out and voters stop "wasting" votes on them); **PR → multiparty.**

- **The two mechanisms — *why* it happens (this is the heart of the law):**
  - ① **Mechanical effect** — with **one seat per district won by a plurality**, only the **top-1** converts votes → a seat. A party that comes **3rd** (or is **broad-but-thin**, spread across the country) wins **nothing** despite a real vote share → those votes are simply **wasted**. *(UKIP 2015: **12.6% of the vote → 1 seat**; SNP, geographically concentrated, fewer votes → **56 seats**.)*
  - ② **Psychological effect** — voters **know** this, so they stop "wasting" votes on no-hopers and **strategically switch** to a viable **top-2** candidate; donors and candidates desert small parties too → this **reinforces** the squeeze. **Under PR** (seats ≈ vote share) *both* pressures vanish → **multiparty survives.**
- **But not deterministic:** it holds in *established* democracies; in **new/diverse** democracies voters aren't strategic (ethnic/identity voting persists), so FPTP can still produce many parties (Moser & Scheiner) — see **India**. And it can break even in old democracies (**France 2017**: Macron's one-year-old party upended a near-two-party system).

## Party systems

***Core:*** classify a system by the **number & relative strength** of parties. First, *what parties are for*; then the three types; then where they come from.

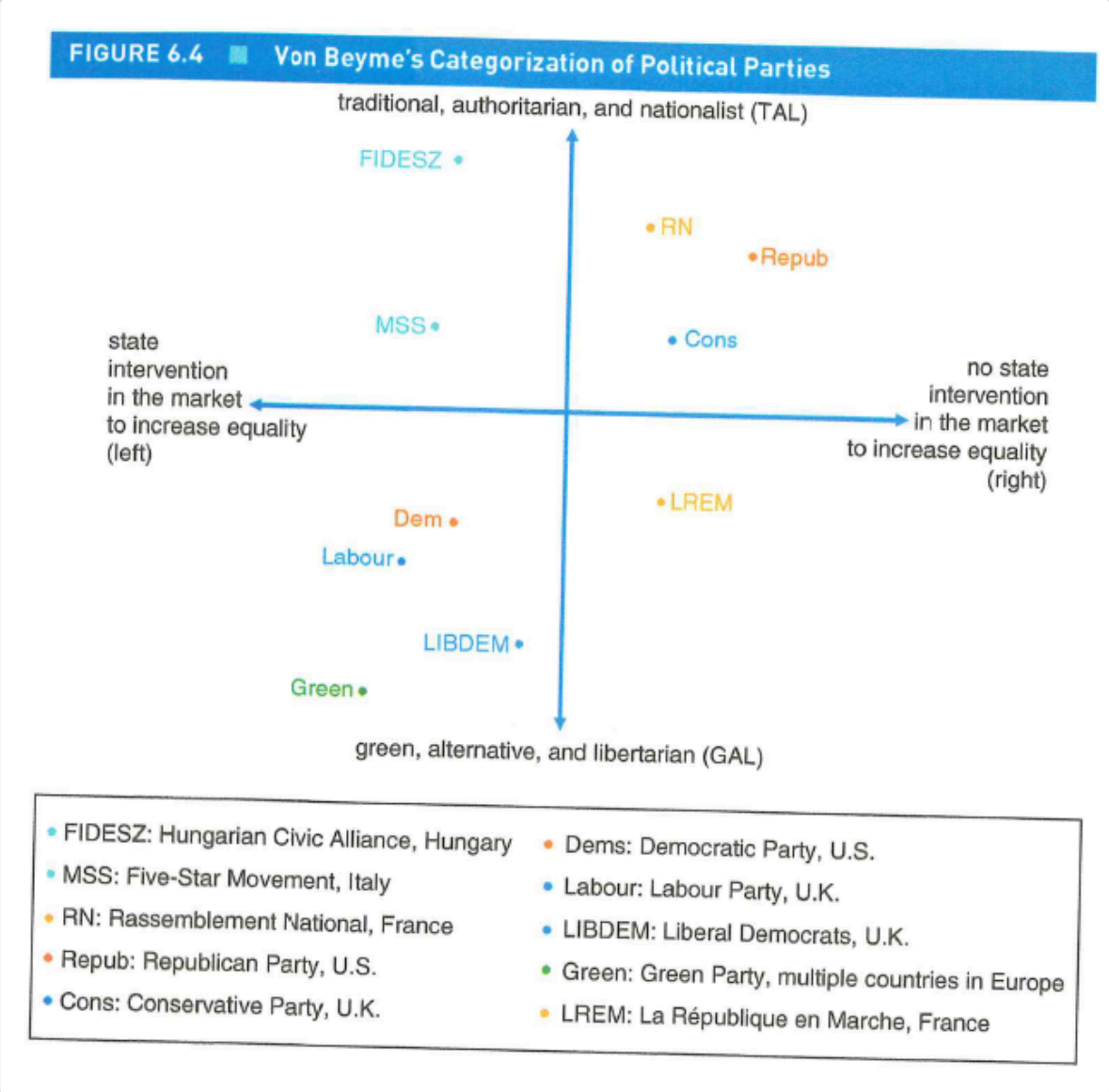
- **What parties do — five functions (FK deck):** ① **mobilise** citizens to participate · ② **recruit** the political elite (candidates/leaders) · ③ **simplify** choices (a label voters can reason with) · ④ **organise government** (form and run the executive/legislature) · ⑤ **provide opposition** (a government-in-waiting that scrutinises). *(This is what distinguishes parties from interest groups below — parties **seek office**; interest groups only seek influence.)*
- **The three types — by number & strength:**
  - **Dominant-party:** many parties compete in more-or-less free & fair elections, but **one wins *every* election** and governs continuously (**ANC**, South Africa — won all six post-apartheid elections, though its share fell to **57.5% in 2019**). **Key nuance:** the line to an **electoral-authoritarian regime** (ch. 8) is *thin* — the test is *how* the party keeps winning: by genuine **popularity** (still a democracy) vs by **manipulating the rules, using state resources, and intimidating rivals** (authoritarian).
  - **Two-party:** only **two** parties can realistically win, though more compete (**US** — no third party significant since the Republicans emerged in the 1850s; UK). Third parties (Ross Perot's Reform Party) flare up but **rarely survive more than two elections.**
  - **Multiparty: more than two** parties could win and govern → **coalitions**. Two sub-variants: **(a)** two large parties, one usually needing small partners to reach a majority (**Italy**); **(b)** three-four roughly equal parties, a majority *always* needing a coalition of ≥2.
- **Where party systems come from — two rival explanations** (the answer to "*why do some countries have 2 parties and others 6?*"):
  - **Sociological — parties grow out of social *cleavages*.** A party forms to represent a self-conscious social group, so the **number of parties mirrors how many deep social divisions a society has.** Two classic 19th-century European cleavages:
    - **Economic (capital vs labour)** — became **universal** with industrialisation: *every* country got a **business/"liberal" party** *and* a **workers' party** (socialist/social-democratic). This one cleavage alone yields **two** party families.
    - **Religious** — existed in **some** countries, not all: **Germany** has a Christian party (CDU/CSU) speaking for a Catholic minority in a Protestant country; **France**, almost entirely Catholic, never needed one.
    - **The rule:** each *additional* salient cleavage tends to add a party family → **both economic + religious salient = multiparty; only economic salient = two-party.**
  - **Institutional (Duverger) — the *electoral rules* shape the party count.** Rational politicians build whatever kind of party *wins under the given rules*, so the **system** drives the number, not just society. **Under SMD** you must come **first in a district** to win *anything*, via two mechanisms (see Duverger's Law): **(i) mechanical** — small/ideological parties get **no seats** and wither, and **(ii) psychological** — voters **stop "wasting" votes** on no-hopers → politics collapses toward **two** broad catch-all parties. **Under PR** (seats ≈ vote share) *both* pressures vanish → **multiparty survives.**
- **Bridging the "chicken-and-egg":** the institutional effect holds in **established** democracies but *not* in **new** ones, where voters aren't strategic (ethnic/identity voting persists, FPTP winners take seats on 20–30%) — Boix; Moser & Scheiner. **France** is the classic Duverger case (its two-round SMD pushed a fragmented system to ~two blocs, 82% of seats by 2012) — until **2017**, when Macron's one-year-old party blew it up.

## How parties mobilise — and the "crisis of party democracy"

***Core:*** parties win support in **three distinct ways** — how a party mobilises tells you what *kind* of party it is:

| Type | How it wins votes | Signature | Where it thrives |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Programmatic** | offers **ideas / ideology / policy** — you vote for its platform | manifestos, left–right positioning | established, richer democracies |
| **Patronage / clientelist** | trades **material benefits for votes**, delivered through local **brokers** | jobs, cash, favours, "get out the vote" machines | poorer / newer & **statist** economies |
| **Populist** | a **personalist leader** frames **"the people" vs a "corrupt elite"** | crisis rhetoric, anti-establishment, deliberate "**bad manners**" | anywhere in a "crisis of party democracy" |

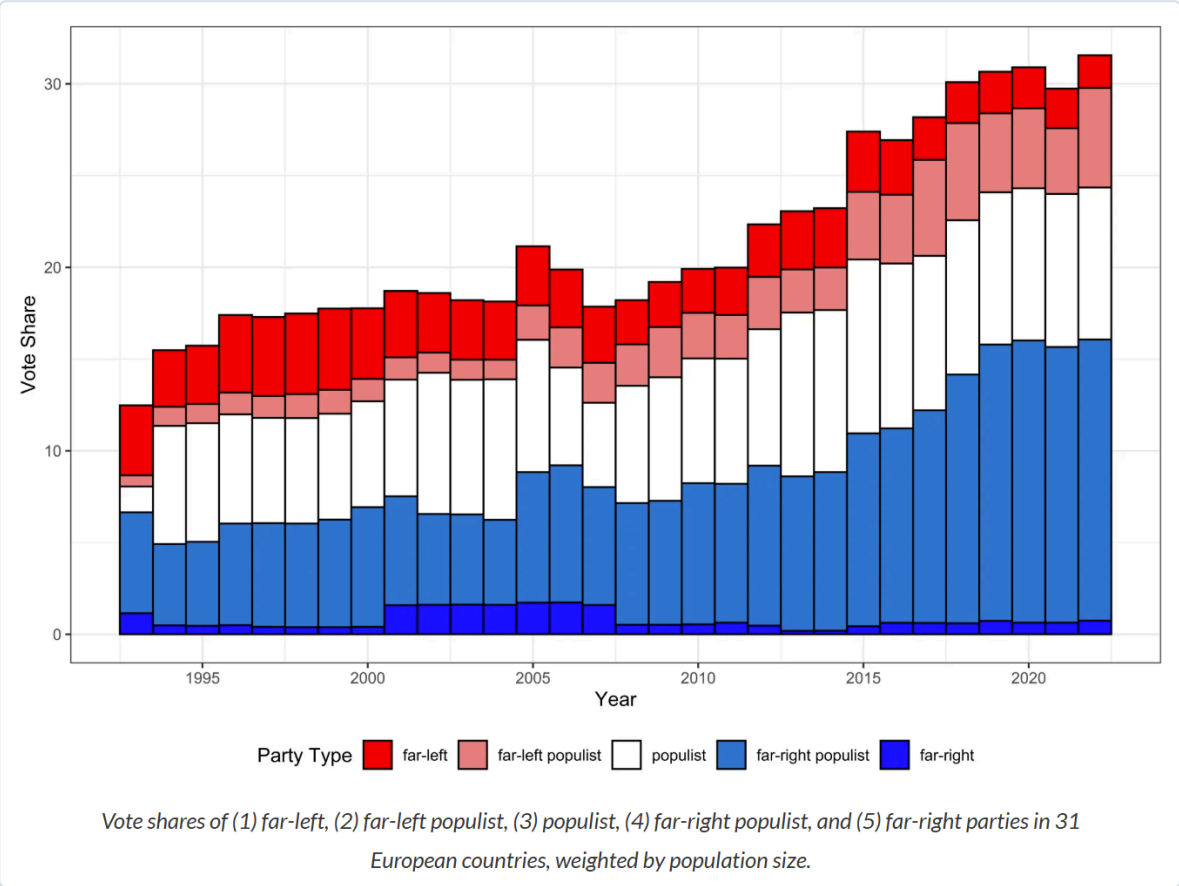
- **Where parties sit — two ideology axes (FK):** parties map onto **two** dimensions, not one — the classic **economic Left–Right** (redistribution: *state intervention to increase equality* ⇄ *no intervention*) *plus* the modern cultural **GAL–TAN** — **GAL** (Green/Alternative/Libertarian: progressive, cosmopolitan, pro-environment, individual rights) vs **TAN/TAL** (Traditional/Authoritarian/Nationalist). Today's populist/far-right parties (Farage, Salvini, AfD) mobilise mainly on the **TAN** end of this *second* axis.




**How to read it (Von Beyme, OD Fig. 6.4).** The **horizontal axis = economics** (left = *state intervention to increase equality*; right = *no intervention*); the **vertical axis = culture/values** (bottom = **GAL**; top = **TAL/TAN**).

A party's position is the *pair* of coordinates — e.g. **Labour/Dems** sit centre-left & GAL-ish, **RN (Rassemblement National)** & **FIDESZ** sit right & strongly **TAL**, **Greens** sit far GAL. The point: two parties can share an economic position yet be opposites on culture — which is exactly how the far-right mobilises on the *TAN* axis without moving economically.

- *Caveat on "programmatic":* **Achen & Bartels** ("folk theory" critique) argue voters mostly vote by **social identity**, not by carefully weighing ideas — so pure programmatic appeal is partly a myth.
- **Crisis of party democracy:** only ~**20%** trust parties (though ~80% value democracy); falling loyalty/membership/turnout, rising **electoral volatility**, single-issue/postmaterialist voting, and **far-right/anti-system** parties (nativism, post-2015 refugee crisis). Explanations: economic (globalisation, manufacturing decline); **dealignment** (voters detach from all parties) vs **realignment** (they switch); catch-all parties → "**cartel parties**" (Mair) colluding at the centre → lost efficacy.




*Vote shares of (1) far-left, (2) far-left populist, (3) populist, (4) far-right populist, and (5) far-right parties in 31 European countries, weighted by population size.*

**How to read it (The PopuList, Rooduijn et al. 2024).** Each bar = one year's **combined vote share** of anti-establishment parties across 31 European countries; the colours split them into far-left, far-left-populist, populist, **far-right-populist (blue)** and far-right. The story is the **near-doubling** from ~12% (1993) to ~31% (2022), and that most of the growth is the **blue far-right-populist** band — the empirical face of the "crisis of party democracy."

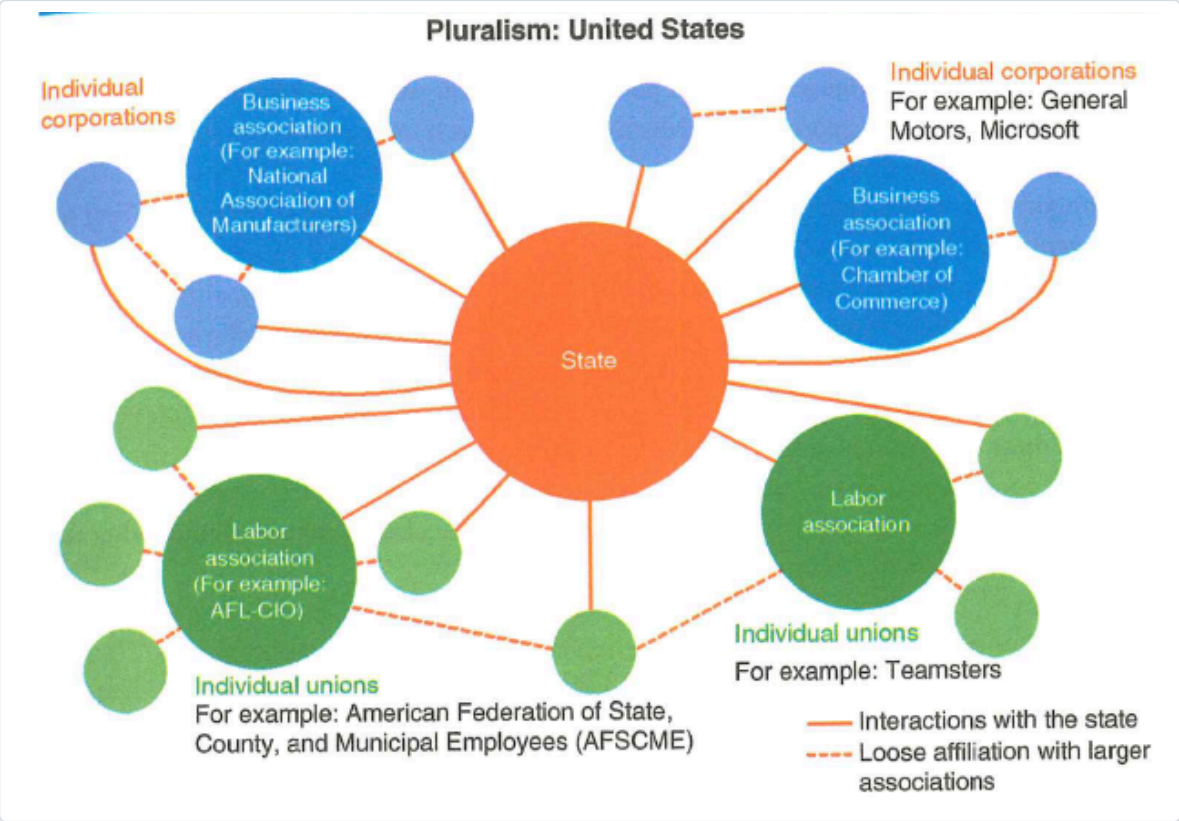
- **US exception:** not dealignment but partisan **sorting/polarisation** (Abramowitz), racial realignment, and Trump's **status-threat** populism (Mutz 2018).

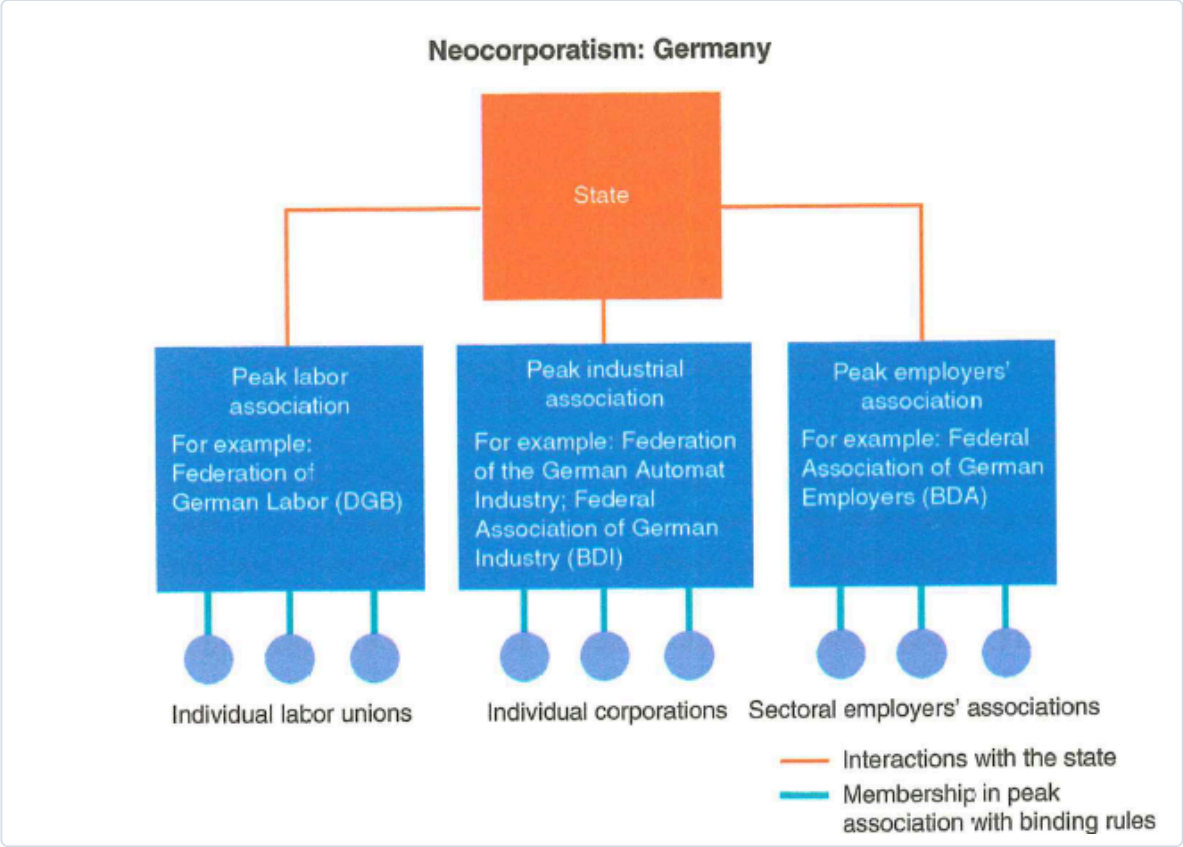
## Civil society & interest groups — pluralism vs neocorporatism

***Core:*** beyond parties, organised **interest groups** (they *don't* seek office, unlike parties) represent society — in two rival models. Groups grew sector-by-sector: first **labour, business, agriculture**, then **women/minority**

groups; in divided societies, ethnic/religious groups dominate (some, like the KKK, are internally *undemocratic* — a tension for democracy).

- **Pluralism** (US): **many** competing groups, a **neutral** state; easy entry & local control, but fragmented clout — and **business is inherently privileged** (Lindblom). **Schattschneider's** famous jab: "*the flaw in the pluralist heaven is that the heavenly chorus sings with a strong upper-class accent*" — i.e. who *gets organised* is skewed toward the well-off.
- **Neocorporatism** / societal corporatism (Germany, N. Europe): a **few large, hierarchical peak associations** the state recognises as *the* voice of each sector negotiate **binding** deals; more influence (esp. for labour countering business) but **less participatory** (little incentive to form new groups). *(State corporatism = the mandated, authoritarian version — ch. 8.)*
- **Social-capital debate:** Putnam (*Bowling Alone*) sees civic **decline**; Skocpol adds that mass-membership bodies gave way to **managed advocacy**; critics (Dalton, "**Kicking in Groups**") reply that activity just **moved to new forms** (movements, single-issue groups).






**How to read them (OD).** *Pluralism (US, first diagram):* **many** groups orbit a **neutral** state, connected by thin/loose lines — lots of competing voices, easy entry, but **fragmented** clout and no single channel. *Neocorporatism (Germany, second):* the state is formally wired to just **a few large peak associations** (peak labour DGB, peak industry BDI, peak employers BDA), each sitting *above* its own member firms/unions — fewer, **binding** channels → more influence (esp. for labour) but **harder for new groups** to break in. Same job (representing interests), opposite architecture: *many-and-loose* vs *few-and-binding*.

## The master trade-off (Powell)

***Core:*** systems open to **diversity** (PR · multiparty · pluralism) maximise **representation & participation** but blur **accountability & governability**; **majoritarian** systems (FPTP · two-party) do the reverse. *There is no free lunch — every design chooses a point on this line.* The chapter's most robust finding: **PR represents women far better than SMD** (India goes further with **reserved seats**).

## Cases & examples

**Why these cases are here — circle them back.** Each shows **one electoral/party system in action** and *who it represents vs leaves out*. Read each for: *which system · how votes became seats · who got left out.*

| Case | Electoral system | Party system | What it shows |
|---|---|---|---|
| UK | SMD/FPTP | two-party | extreme disproportionality (UKIP 12.6% → 1 seat) |
| Germany | mixed **compensatory** PR | multiparty | how mixed PR lets new parties (Greens, AfD) in |
| Japan | mixed **noncompensatory** | dominant (LDP) | more majoritarian; Duverger working haltingly |
| India | SMD/FPTP + federal | multiparty | Duverger's limits in a diverse democracy; reserved seats |
| Brazil | **open-list PR** (no threshold) | fragmented | weak-party fragmentation (30 parties) + populism |
| Israel | pure closed-list PR | hyper-multiparty | PR instability under extreme diversity |

- **UK — SMD/FPTP.** The paradigm two-party FPTP system: modest vote margins → big seat majorities → single-party government. But it's wildly **disproportional** — in **2015, UKIP won 12.6% of the vote → 1 seat**, while the **SNP won fewer votes → 56 seats** (geographically concentrated in Scotland). → *SMD/FPTP → disproportionality, wasted votes, majoritarian governance.*
- **Germany — mixed compensatory PR.** Designed after Weimar with a **5% threshold** + compensatory mixed PR → a stable multiparty system. The **Greens (1983)** got in *because* the semiproportional system let them clear the threshold (unlike Britain's Greens); by **2017** the two big parties fell to a record **54%**, and the far-right **AfD** won its first seats. **Note (2023 reform):** to stop the house ballooning (736 seats in 2021), Germany **capped it at 630** and **scrapped overhang/compensatory seats** — seats now follow the **list vote** and a district win no longer guarantees a seat, so it's arguably become **personalised PR** rather than truly "mixed." → *Mixed PR sustains a multiparty system and lets new/ideological parties gain representation — though the 2023 reform pushes it toward pure PR.*
- **Japan — mixed noncompensatory.** The **LDP dominated 1955–93** via factions & clientelism; the **1994 reform** (300 SMD + 180 PR, *noncompensatory*) pushed toward two parties — the **DPJ won 308/480 in 2009**, but the **LDP swept back in 2012** ("lucky, not popular" — a split opposition). → *Noncompensatory mixed = more majoritarian than Germany; Duverger's Law working haltingly.*
- **India — FPTP in a diverse federation.** FPTP "should" give two parties, but **huge diversity + federalism** yields many *state-level* two-party fights that aggregate into a **national multiparty** system (parties: 50 in 1952 → 342 in 2009). **BJP (Modi) 2014: 31% of the vote → 52% of seats** under FPTP. **120 of ~600** seats are **reserved** for lower castes/tribes. → *Duverger's limits in a new/diverse democracy; reserved-seat representation.*
- **Brazil — open-list PR, no threshold.** No incentive for intra-party cooperation → extreme fragmentation (**30 parties by 2018**) and weak, local parties (a third of legislators switched parties 1989–95). Recession + the "car wash" scandal → mass protests → **Rousseff impeached (2016)** → outsider populist **Bolsonaro won 2018** atop a tiny party. → *Open-list PR's weak-party fragmentation + accountability failure + populism.*
- **Israel — pure PR.** The whole country is **one district**, a 120-seat Knesset, **3.25% threshold** → ~a dozen parties win; governments = a big party + 3–6 small ones, lasting ~2 years; **2019 produced three elections in one year.** → *PR's instability under extreme diversity — the cost of maximal proportionality.*

## Key terms

| Term | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Collective-action problem | Individuals rationally don't act (vote) though all suffer if none do |
| Electoral system | Legal mechanism translating votes into offices/seats |
| Single-member district (SMD) | Each district elects one representative |
| Plurality / FPTP | Most votes wins (no majority needed) |
| Majoritarian | Winner needs an absolute majority (50%+1) |
| Two-round system (runoff) | If no 50%+1 in round 1, top candidates meet in a second-round runoff (France) |
| Alternative Vote (AV) / ranked-choice | Rank candidates; eliminate last-placed & transfer their votes until one passes 50% |
| Proportional representation (PR) | Seats = vote share (national/large districts + a threshold) |
| Closed-list PR | Vote for a party; the **party** sets the candidate order (party control, quotas) — Israel |
| Open-list PR | Vote for party **and** a candidate; candidates' own votes set the order (voter choice, weaker parties) — Brazil |
| Mixed / semiproportional | SMD seats + party-list PR (compensatory / noncompensatory) |
| Duverger's Law | SMD → two parties; PR → multiparty |
| Party system | Number & strength of parties (dominant / two-party / multiparty) |
| Programmatic / patronage / populist mobilisation | Win support by ideas / material rewards / anti-elite personalism |
| Interest-group pluralism | Many competing groups, neutral state (US) |
| Neocorporatism | Few peak associations bargain binding deals with the state (Germany) |
| Peak association | Body uniting a whole sector to negotiate with the state |
| Social capital | Networks + norms of reciprocity underpinning civil society |
| Powell trade-off | Diverse representation ⇄ clear accountability |

## Exam pointers

- Reproduce the **electoral-systems comparison** cold — how each converts votes→seats, its effect on the **number of parties (Duverger)**, **proportionality**, **turnout**, and **women/minorities** — with a case each.
- Answer both spine questions: **why participate** (collective-action problem; institutions shape turnout) and **whose interests get represented** (electoral → party → interest-group chain).
- State **Duverger's Law** *and* its limits (India; France 2017).
- Contrast **pluralism vs neocorporatism** (US vs Germany) for interest representation.
- Land on the **Powell trade-off** (representation ⇄ accountability) and the robust finding that **PR represents women better**; use **Iversen & Soskice** to link PR → more redistribution.

## ★ Fun facts & memorable details

> Sticky stats, dates & quotes from Lecture 5 (participation & representation).

### Quotable

- Schattschneider (1942): "*Modern democracy is unthinkable save in terms of parties.*"
- Downs (1957): for most people, voting is technically **irrational** — the seed of the collective-action problem.
- Powell's master **trade-off:** representation/participation ⇄ accountability/governability.

### Striking numbers

- **UK 2015:** UKIP won **12.6% → 1 seat**; the SNP won *fewer* votes → **56 seats.**
- **US 2012 House:** in the ten most gerrymandered states, Republicans won **7% more votes but 76% more seats.**
- **Israel:** whole country = one district; **3.25% threshold**; **three elections in one year (2019)**; governments last ~2 years.
- **India:** parties grew **50 (1952) → 342 (2009)**; **120 of ~600** seats reserved for lower castes/tribes; BJP 2014 = **31% of vote → 52% of seats.**
- **Brazil 2018:** its most fragmented legislature ever — **30 parties.**
- **Women in legislatures:** Nordic countries lead at **42.5%**; US House only **23.4%** (2019). Robust finding: **PR elects more women than SMD.**
- Only **~20%** of citizens trust parties, though ~**80%** call democracy "a very good thing."
- **Maine 2018:** first US Congress seat decided by **ranked-choice** — Golden won 50.5–49.5 after trailing on the first count.

### Memorable

- **France:** the top two parties held **56% of Assembly seats (1973) → 82% (2012)** — then the system **collapsed in 2017** with Macron's one-year-old party.
- **~60 countries** used FPTP in 2019 — almost all former British colonies; **Belarus** was the only continental-European one.
- The social-capital debate in two titles: Putnam's ***Bowling Alone*** vs its rebuttal "**Kicking in Groups.**"